CLASS 8 — SOCIAL SCIENCE CHAPTER TEST SET A

Chapter 10: **A Journey Through Indian Architecture** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Draw neat maps and diagrams wherever required.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. ‘Architecture’ is best described as: 1

(a) the making of tools for farming
(b) the art and techniques of design and construction combining use and beauty
(c) the study of old coins
(d) only the painting of walls

2. Harappan wells did not collapse inward under pressure because they were built with: 1

(a) mud walls only
(b) trapezoid-shaped bricks that lock together
(c) iron rings
(d) round pebbles

3. The stone railings carved with the names of donors are a feature of the stupa at: 1

(a) Bishnupur **(b)** Bharhut **(c)** Orchha **(d)** Dholavira

4. Sharada Peetha in Kashmir is remembered as a: 1

(a) stepwell of Gujarat
(b) Mughal tomb
(c) fort of the Rajputs
(d) famous centre of learning linked to the Sharada script

5. A pushkarini is a: 1

(a) water reservoir attached to a temple **(b)** type of fort gate
(c) royal garden **(d)** tower above a shrine

6. The vertical plan of a temple is compared to the body of the: 1

(a) Mughal emperor **(b)** Purusha, the cosmic being
(c) local king **(d)** temple priest

7. Mosques have a prayer hall facing: 1

(a) the east gate **(b)** Delhi
(c) Mecca **(d)** the nearest river

8. The Agra Fort got its red colour from sandstone mined at: 1

(a) Dholpur in Rajasthan **(b)** Madurai
(c) Ajanta in Maharashtra **(d)** Mount Abu

9. A traditional Indian house for richer families was often planned around a: 1

(a) central courtyard **(b)** glass dome
(c) moat **(d)** tall minaret

10. **Assertion (A):** Harappan wells did not collapse inward easily. 1
Reason (R): They were made with trapezoid-shaped bricks that lock together.
(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
(c) A is true but R is false
(d) A is false but R is true

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 10–15 words each.

11. What is architecture? 2

12. Why were most Harappan cities built of bricks? 2

13. Name two features of Harappan town planning. 2

14. What is a stupa? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 30–40 words each.

15. Describe the main features of Harappan architecture. 3

16. How did Dholavira differ from Mohenjo-daro? 3

17. Describe the Sanchi Stupa and its importance. 3

OR

Why did early Buddhist art use symbols for the Buddha? 3

18. Describe the Udayagiri–Khandagiri caves. 3

OR

Explain how Ellora's cave no. 10 is built and used. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 80–100 words each.

19. Describe Harappan architecture with reference to Mohenjo-daro and Dholavira. 5

OR

Explain the features and importance of stupa architecture with examples. 5

20. Describe rock-cut architecture at Udayagiri–Khandagiri and Ellora. 5

OR

Explain the importance of water structures in India with examples. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 40 Marks